



Whose Brand Is It Anyway? Building Creative Salience.

You're spending billions building someone else's brand.

Creators, fragmented platforms, and GenAI have broken your control over how your brand shows up. As a result, a significant portion of your media investment is not being attributed back to your brand. Your ads are seen, but not remembered as yours. Instead, most marketers are donating money to build the category.

At the core of this issue is the inconsistent use of distinctive brand assets: the cues you've spent years and millions building, from your logo and colors to packshots and taglines.

CreativeX analysis of 1.4M ads reveals the scale of the problem: 61% of ads fail to use sufficient brand cues to reliably encode memory. That means your media spend is not building long-term brand equity.

When brands get this right, the impact on their advertising is immediate:

- **+28% higher ad recall**
- **45% lower cost per completed view**

At scale, this represents a \$52 billion efficiency opportunity.

For winning in an AI-first marketing world, the mandate is clear. **Ads must do more than capture attention. They must be remembered as yours.**

28%

Higher ad recall
driven with four or
more brand cues.

86%

Higher ad recall
through the usage
of just logo +
packshot.

\$52Bn

In potential
efficiencies across
the advertising
industry.

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I

Understanding the Value of Brand

Advertising's answer to compound interest.

As content scales across creators, platforms, and AI, maintaining control over how your brand shows up becomes exponentially harder.

What was once tightly managed is now fragmented. Making it increasingly difficult to ensure your ads are consistently recognizable as yours.

The result: your media investment is working, but not always for your brand.



“As content production accelerates across markets and brand partners, maintaining *consistent brand identity* & recognition becomes significantly *more complex*.”

Celine Baudin

GLOBAL HEAD OF CONTENT AND
INTEGRATED COMMUNICATIONS, BAYER

Brand equity is your most valuable asset, and it compounds over time.

Color. Shape. Sound. Packaging. Characters. Every major brand has spent years and hundreds of millions of dollars building the signals that make them instantly recognizable. The shorthand between these signals and your brand in the consumer's mind is one of the most valuable long-term assets your brand controls.

Every time a consumer encounters a brand signal, the recognition gets a little faster, a little more automatic, and a little more valuable.

The more consistently your brand signals show up, the stronger connection they make for consumers. The stronger they get, the less it costs to activate them. This cycle is the closest thing marketing has to compound interest.

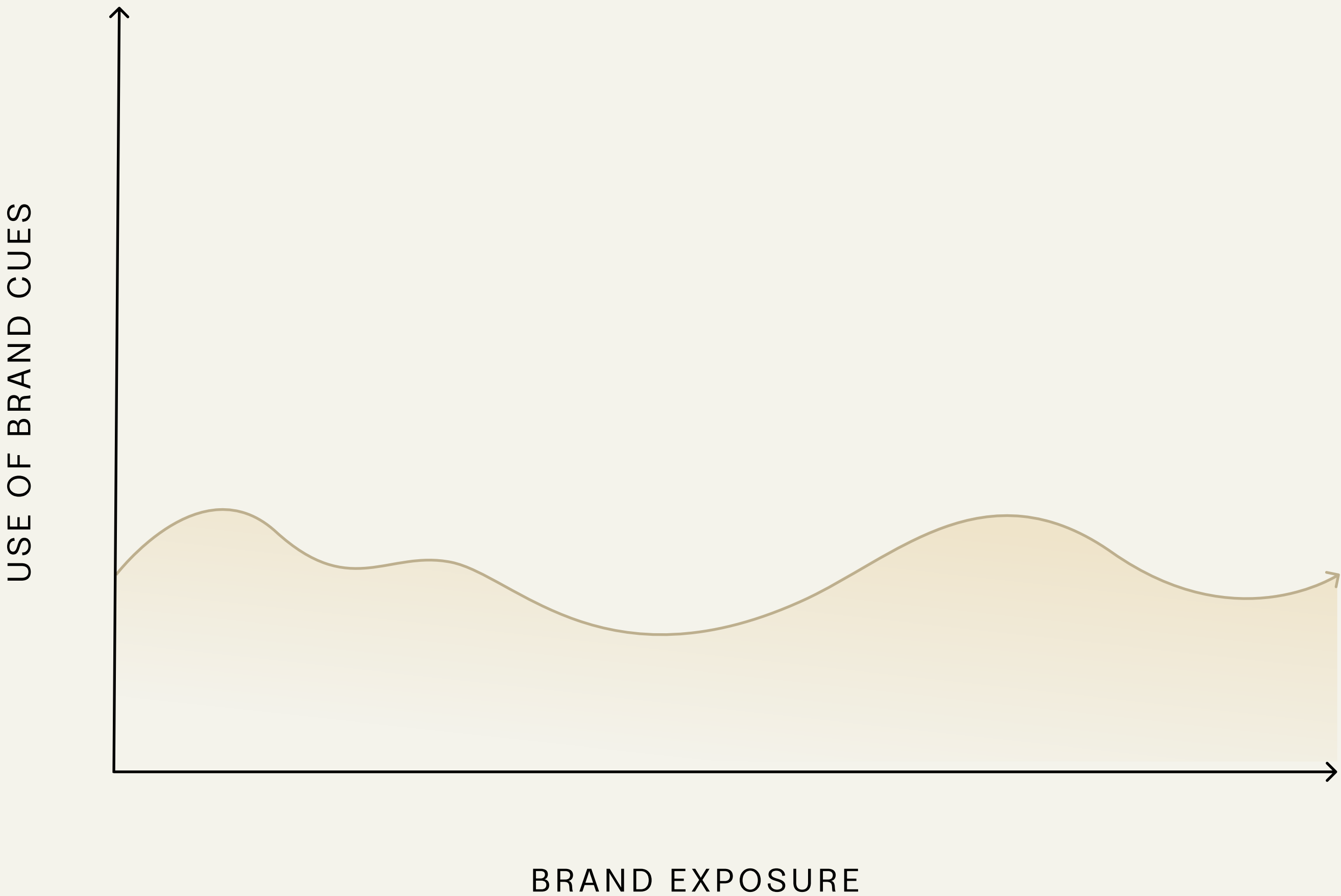


But brand equity only compounds when your ads are recognized as yours.

The investment you’ve made in brand building or advertising is not being connected back to your brand.

Your content is increasingly in other people’s hands. GenAI tools and creators are scaling volume faster than human teams can manually review for brand integrity. In fast-moving, fragmented digital feeds, your ads have 1–2 seconds to be recognized. If they’re not, the compounding stops.

The brands that win will be those that ensure their unique signals fire consistently across every market, every agency, every platform, and every creator.



So, how do we define Distinctive Brand Assets?

Sometimes known as brand signals or codes, distinctive brand assets are visual, verbal, or auditory cues that trigger brand recognition without needing to say the brand name.

- 
Logos
- 
Packshots
- 
Mascot
- 
Color
- 
Tagline
- 
Icon
- 
Sonic

This isn't theory.

This analysis is built on **\$2B of real-world advertising data.***

*Yes, this is a large dataset.

\$2Bn

In ad spend
analyzed for the
report research.

176

Brands included in
the analysis,
covering over 105
markets.

300,000

Unique assets, across 1.4 million
ads analyzed in the research.

Too many ads don't include enough brand cues to be remembered, leaving media spend unattributed.

1. The *Attribution* Gap

The 3 ways your advertising is losing value:

Most brands aren't failing because of budget.

Instead, they're losing value in how their ads are built and deployed.

Brand cues are more powerful together, yet they are rarely combined to drive a real impact.

2. The *Multiplier* Effect

WHOSE BRAND IS IT ANYWAY?

Creator content rarely uses brand cues. This means your media spend builds the creator's brand, not yours.

3. The *Loaned* Brand



II

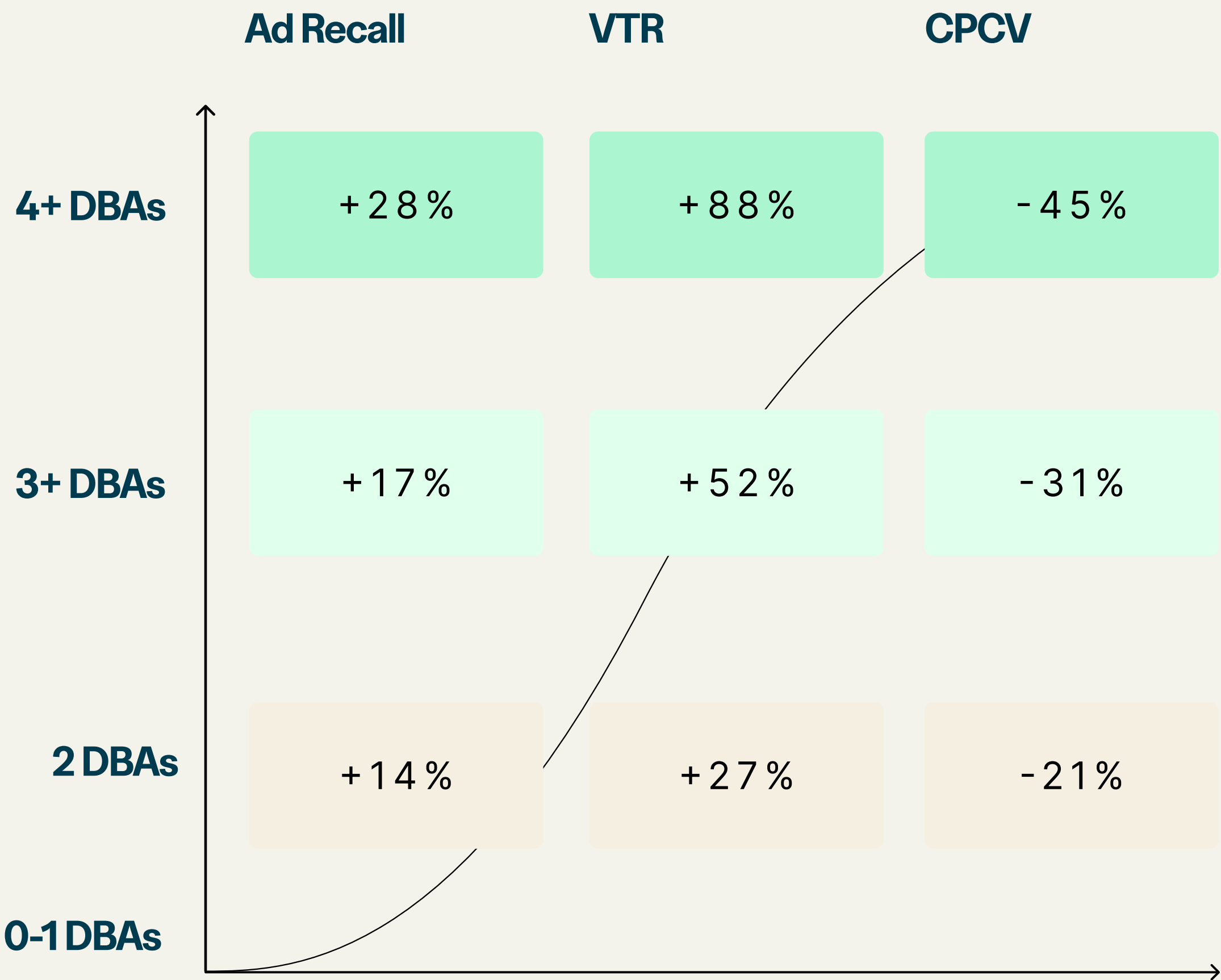
The Attribution Gap

Most ads aren't built to be
remembered as yours.

Most ads are missing the brand signals that drive performance.

Advertisers are leaving billions on the table through inconsistent deployment of DBAs.

Currently, 37% of ads use fewer than two DBAs, and **only 25% hit the "elite" mark of four or more.** The impact of stacking assets is clear.



III

The Multiplier Effect

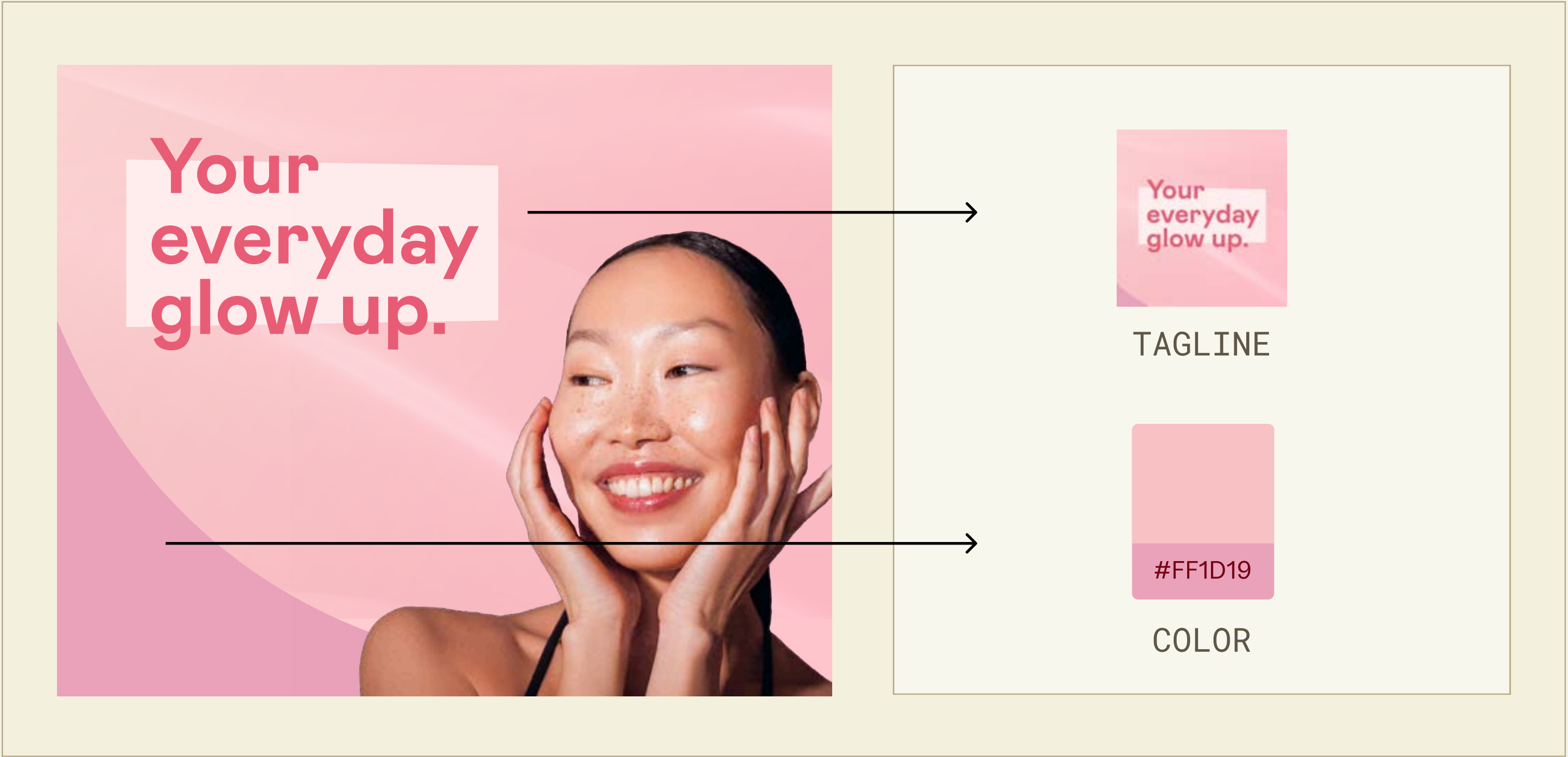
While individual brand assets are common, they are rarely used in the powerful combinations that drive outsized impact on ad recall.

Let's see how these combinations interact in practice.

Color + Tagline

+1%
ad recall

Present in only 25% of ads. Drives 25% higher view through rates.



Tagline + Packshot

+5%
ad recall

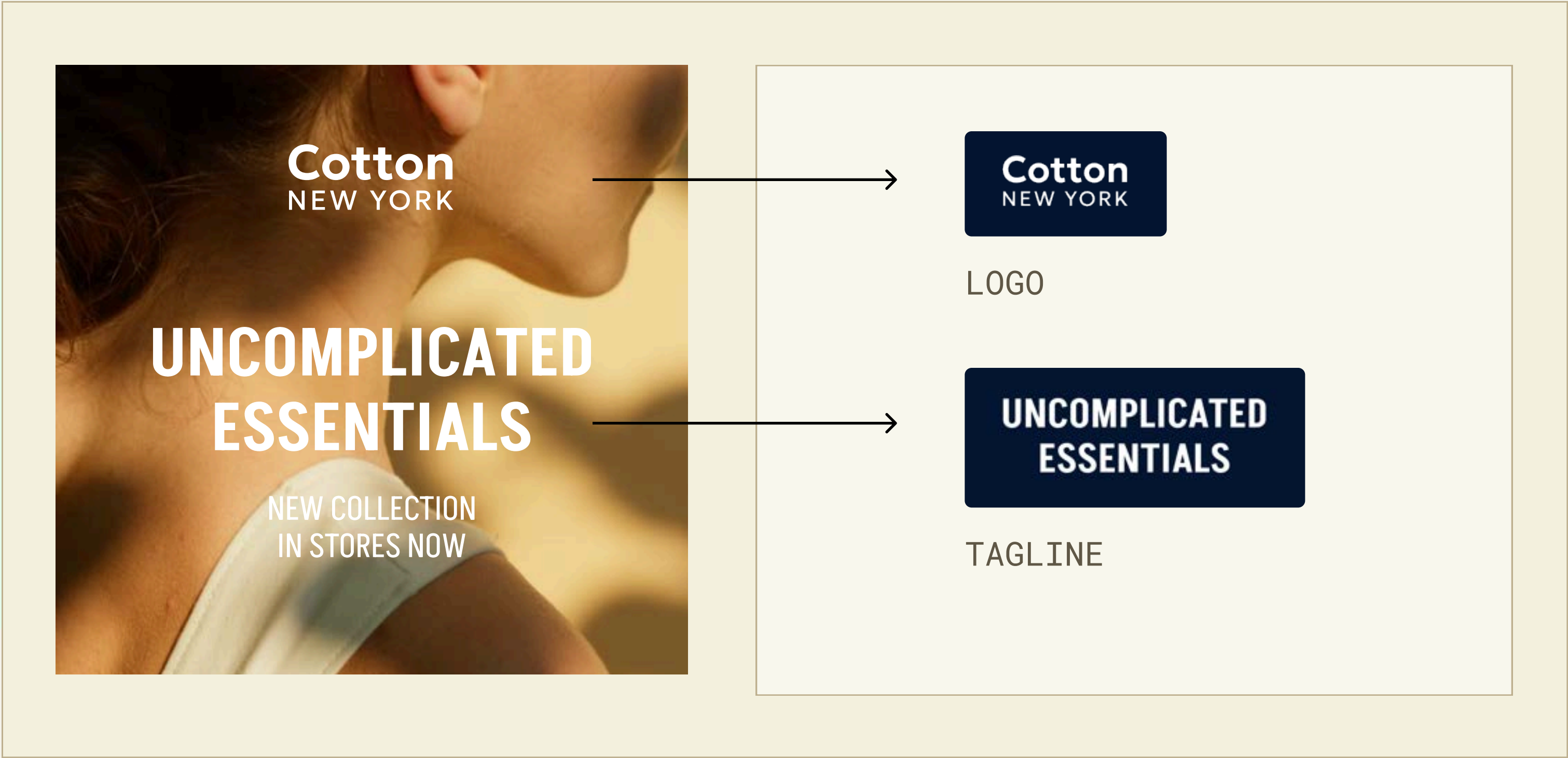
Present in just 23% of ads. Also drives 23% higher view through rates.



Logo + Tagline

+20%
ad recall

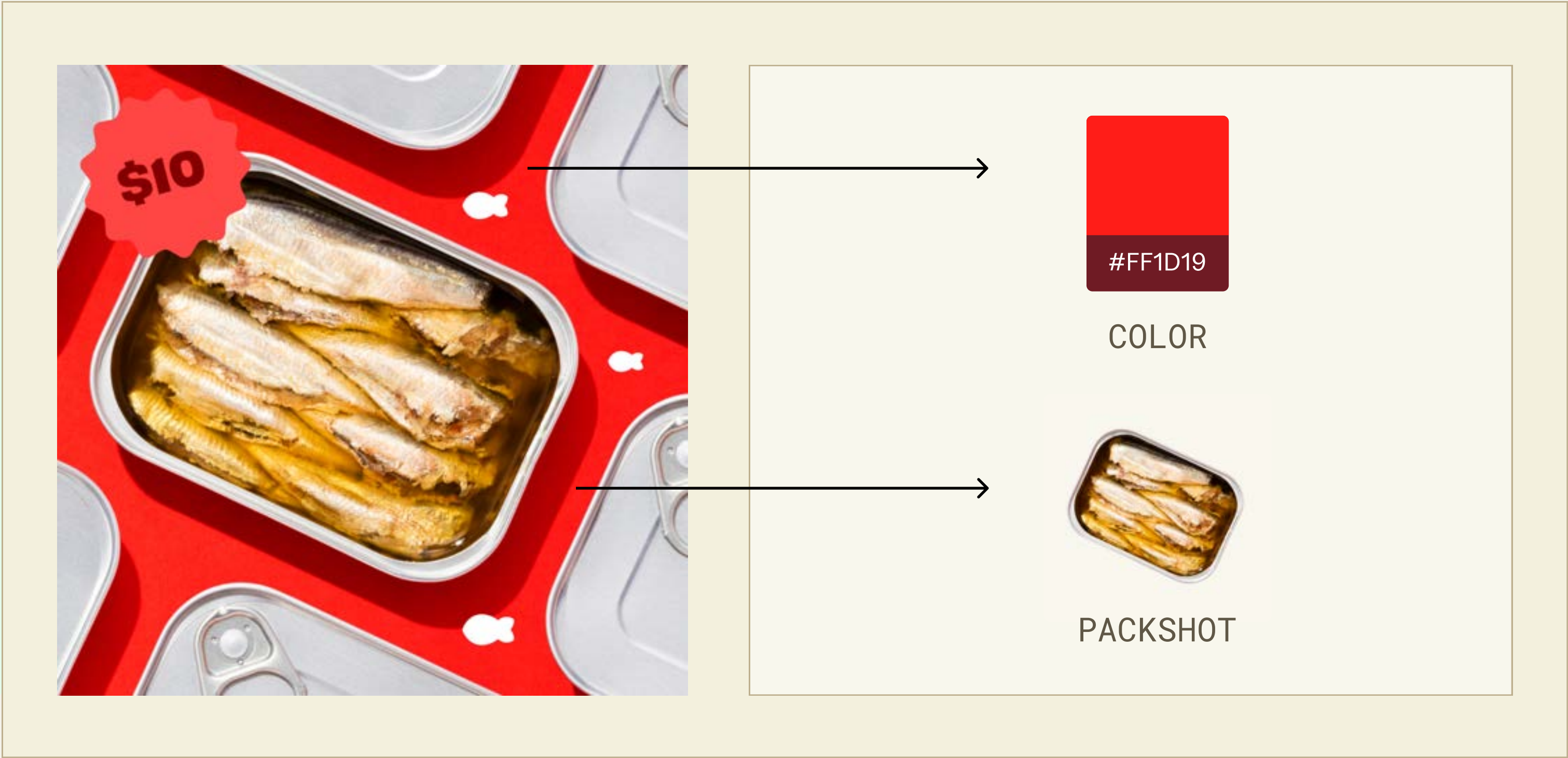
Just 22% of ads contain this combo.
Also associated with 21% higher view
through rates.



Color + Packshot

+34%
ad recall

Present in 49% of
ads, driving an 34%
increase in ad recall.



Logo + Packshot

+86%
ad recall

Present in 58% of
ads. Produces 2%
lower CPMs.



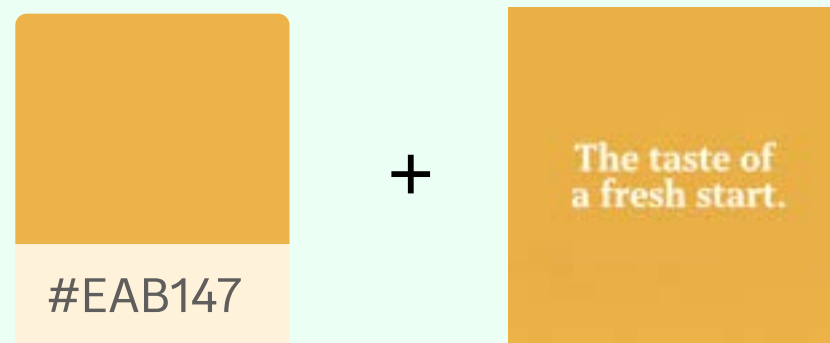
LOGO



PACKSHOT

In short: You're not combining DBAs to drive impact.

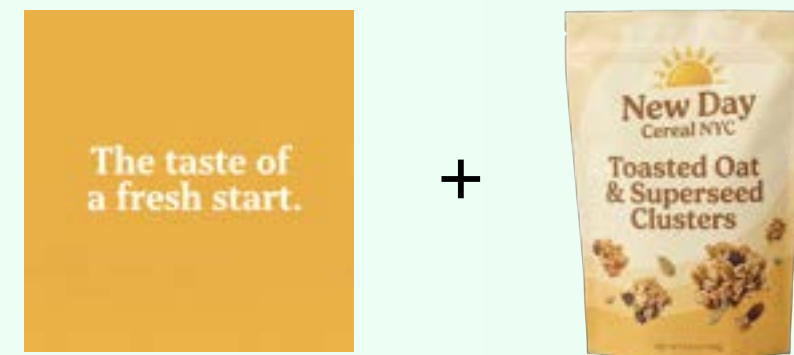
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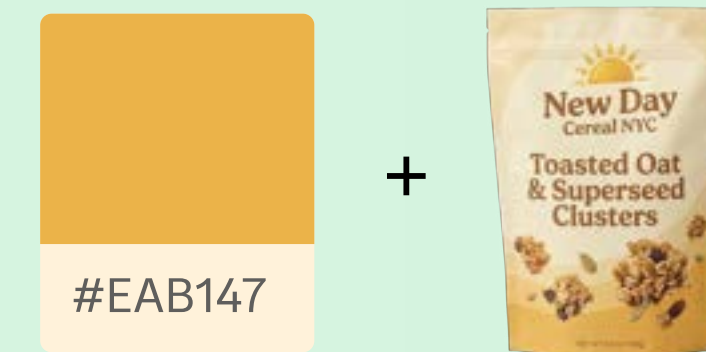
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Logo + Packshot

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Produces 2% lower CPMs.



IV

The Loaned Brand

Creator content often promotes
their personal brand, not yours.

Your media spend is building someone else's brand.

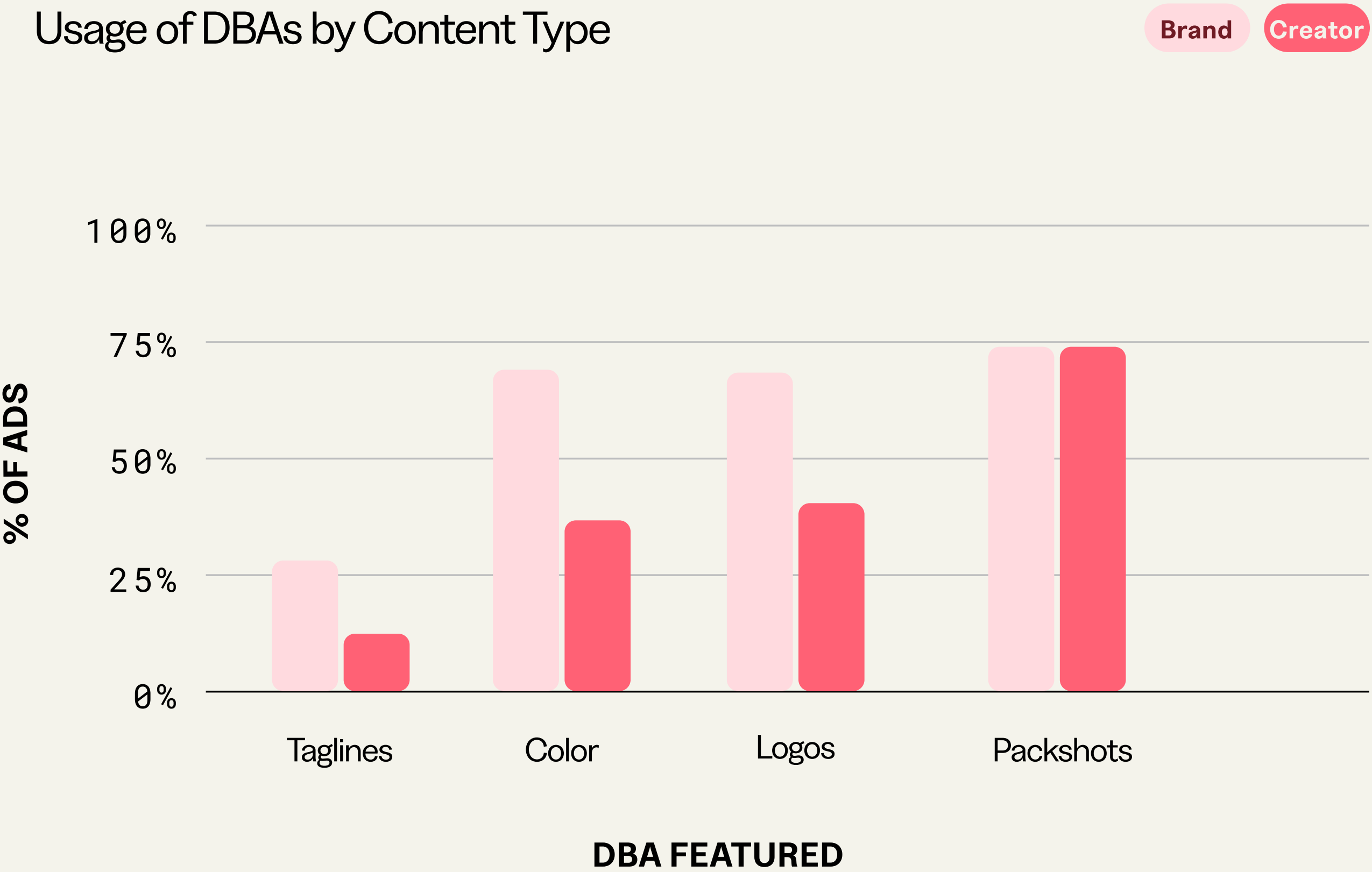
Creators are masters of authenticity, but they struggle with brand suitability. Their content often promotes their personal brand, not yours.

Creators ignore assets that drive attribution:

- Logos: Used nearly half as often as branded content (40% vs. 70%).
- Taglines: Used less than half as often (13% vs. 29%).

45% of creator spend on Meta is unbranded and not watched past the first three seconds, making it effectively wasted. In these cases, you're not partnering with a creator -- you're subsidizing their reach at your own expense.

Usage of DBAs by Content Type



V

Building a Brand System

How industry leaders are
operationalizing at scale.

Consistent brand asset usage drives measurable growth.

The Glass and a Half visual has been used in Cadbury marketing campaigns since 1928, and is one of the brand's most iconic DBAs.

When the Glass and a Half DBA is used in Cadbury ads, the impact on long and short term performance is evident.

Usage of this DBA drives:

- Higher awareness (+6pp)
- Higher recall (+3pp)
- Greater consideration (+3pp)
- Stronger purchase Intent (+11pp)
- Higher Completed Video Views +30%

SLOW MELTING
SMOOTH COATING
LONG LASTING

 Cadbury
DAIRY MILK

Iconic assets only stay iconic if they're used consistently.



“We’ve been gifted iconic assets. Our job is to ensure they maintain that status and build our brands. CreativeX are a key partner for us in making this happen.”

Tim Milwood

GLOBAL INSIGHT LEADER, MONDELEZ

What happens when you turn brand consistency into a system?

For over a century, Bayer's brand equity has been a proxy for trust. By codifying 160 years of heritage into digital Brand Codes, Bayer has bridged the gap between rapid production and rigorous brand standards.

They've moved from static guidance in PDFs to an agentic, real-time system of control. This ensures their content is built to succeed and be remembered as theirs, no matter how it's made or who made it.

Bayer exemplifies when brand consistency is operationalized, every asset contributes to both performance and long-term brand equity.

- **Logo usage:** drove a 12.1% lift in CVV and 7.9% reduction in CPCV.*
- **Brand Color:** results in a 6.2% lift in CVV, 4.5% decrease in CPCV and a, 86.4% lift in Favorability, 24.3% lift in Consideration and 7.5% lift in Recall.



In an AI-first world
Brand Consistency only works
if it's *systematized*.



“CreativeX gives us
visibility into how our
brand’s distinctive assets
are actually appearing in
each of our creative
assets – helping ensure
every media investment
supports creative that
strengthens brand recall,
as well as performance.”

Celine Baudin

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VI

Where to Start

Avoid the question: Whose
Brand is it Anyway?

At this scale, the issue cannot be managed manually.

In a world of creators, GenAI, and high-volume content, ensuring every ad is remembered as yours is no longer a creative challenge but an operational one.

Without a system to control it, DBA usage becomes inconsistent, leading to lost attribution, wasted spend, and diluted brand equity.

Creative Salience is the operational unlock to brand consistency at scale, ensuring every ad reinforces brand memory before your media runs.



Every ad meets a clear standard for brand recognition.



Only recognizable creative is supported by media.



Consistency enforced across creators, markets, and AI content.



A single, live measure of how well your ads are working to build brand memory.

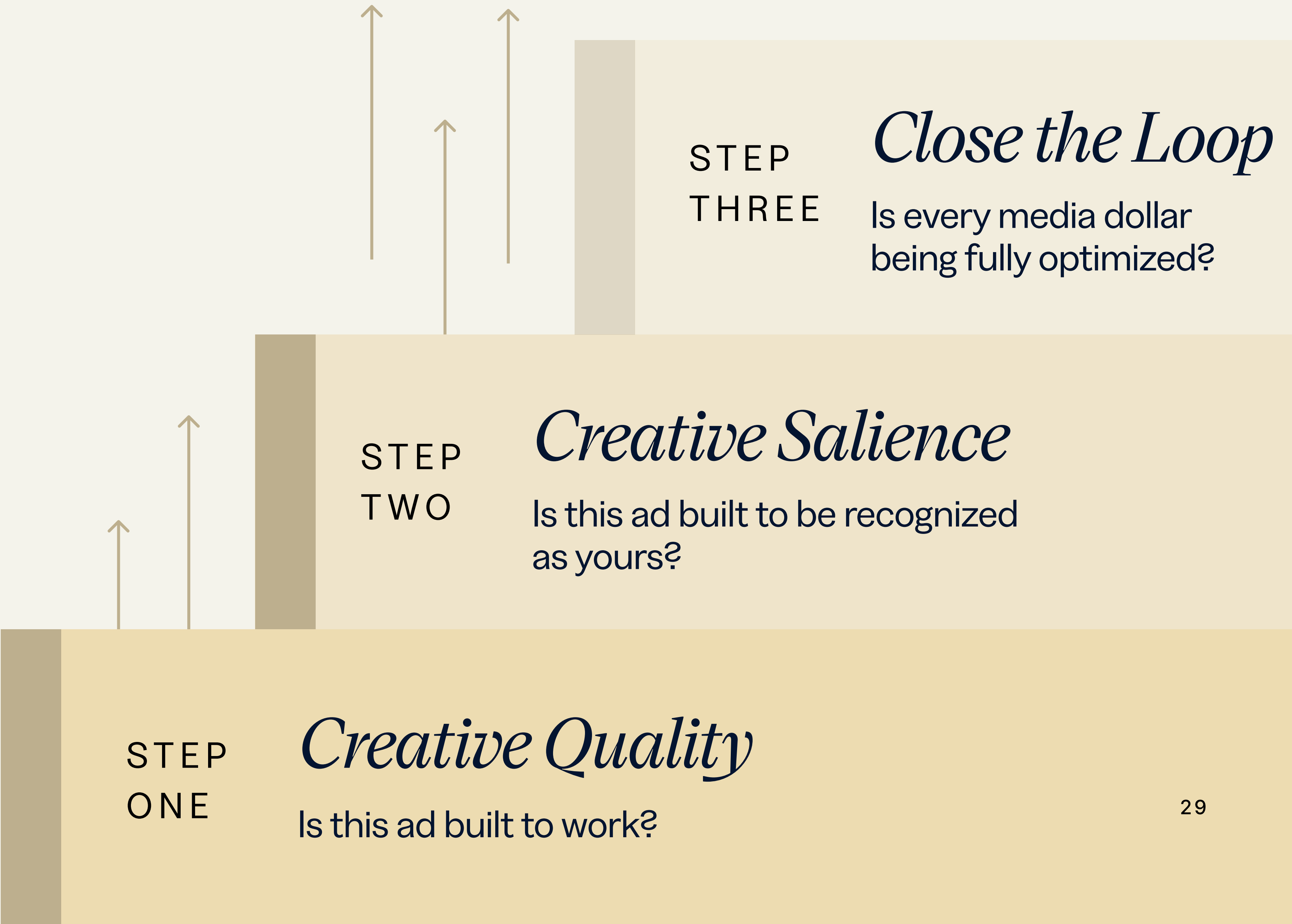
WHERE TO START

CreativeX is the System of Control for Creative, Content, and Media.

The creative excellence journey starts with Creative Quality, making sure your ads perform.

Creative Salience ensures that performance is recognized and remembered as yours.

Together, they help you capture the full value of every impression.



You're spending billions building someone else's brand.
Protect your hard-earned brand equity in 3 steps.

1. Assess.

Do you have visibility into how your brand shows up across all content?

Are you setting a clear standard for brand cue usage?

2. Act.

Audit your advertising to identify where brand cues are missing.

Apply a consistent standard across all assets, including creators and GenAI.

3. Systematize.

Move from brand books to AI-enabled systems that enforce brand consistency at scale.

Every impression should
build your brand.

If it doesn't, you're paying
for value you don't keep.



Isobel Bruce, Elissa Ha,
Purvaja Patel, Angie Quinn